



Week 4 Bayesian approach for classification?

- we can sample from the joint of labels y_n and inputs x_n

$$x^{(i)}, y^{(i)} \sim p(x, y)$$

Task 1.1 Implement a function evaluating the posterior distribution $p(y=1|x)$ and the marginal data distribution

$$p(y=1|x) = \frac{p(x|y=1) p(y=1)}{p(x)} = \frac{\mathcal{N}(x|\mu_1, \Sigma_1) \cdot \tilde{\pi}_1}{\tilde{\pi}_0 \mathcal{N}(x|\mu_0, \Sigma_0) + \tilde{\pi}_1 \mathcal{N}(x|\mu_1, \Sigma_1)}$$

Understanding Laplace approximation

the setup

- N = # of trials (coin flips)
- y = # of successes (heads)
- α_0, β_0 Beta prior parameters
- generative model $y|\theta \sim \text{Bin}(N, \theta)$ $\theta \sim \text{Beta}(1, 1)$

the joint model

$$P(y, \theta) = P(y|\theta)P(\theta) = \underbrace{\binom{N}{y} \theta^y (1-\theta)^{N-y}}_{\text{likelihood}} \underbrace{\frac{1}{\text{Beta}(\alpha_0, \beta_0)}}_{\text{prior}} \theta^{\alpha_0-1} (1-\theta)^{\beta_0-1}$$

$$= \left[\binom{N}{y} B(\alpha_0, \beta_0) \right]^{-1} \theta^{y+\alpha_0-1} (1-\theta)^{N-y+\beta_0-1}$$

taking a logarithm

$$\log P(y, \theta) = \underbrace{\log \binom{N}{y} + \log B(\alpha_0, \beta_0)}_{\text{constant in } \theta = k} + (y + \alpha_0 - 1) \log \theta + (N - y + \beta_0 - 1) \log(1 - \theta)$$

Plugging in numbers

$$f(\theta) + \log P(y, \theta) = \underbrace{\left(\frac{2+1-1}{2} \right)}_2 \log \theta + \underbrace{\left(\frac{12-2+1-1}{10} \right)}_{10} \log(1-\theta) + k = 2 \log \theta + 10 \log(1-\theta) + k$$

Taking the 1st derivative

$$\frac{d}{d\theta} \ln p(y, \theta) = \frac{1}{\theta} - (\beta_0 + N - y - 1) \frac{1}{1-\theta}$$

setting $\frac{d}{d\theta} = 0$ and plugging in

$$0 = \frac{1}{\theta} - \frac{1}{1-\theta}$$

$$0 = \frac{2}{\theta} - \frac{10}{1-\theta}$$

$$0 = 2(1-\theta) - 10\theta$$

$$0 = 2 - 2\theta - 10\theta$$

$$2 = 12\theta \Rightarrow \theta = 0.16 = \theta_{\text{MAP}}$$

alternatively we can use the closed form for Beta Binomial distribution to find the $\theta_{\text{MAP}} = \frac{\alpha_0 + y - 1}{\alpha_0 + \beta_0 + N - 2}$

Taking the 2nd derivative to measure the curvature (Hessian)

$$\frac{d^2}{d\theta^2} = \ln p(y, \theta) = -\frac{1}{\theta^2} - (\beta_0 + N - y - 1) \frac{1}{(1-\theta)^2}$$

$$\text{plugging in} = -\frac{1}{\theta^2} - \frac{1}{(1-\theta)^2} = -\frac{2}{\theta^2} - \frac{10}{(1-\theta)^2}$$

evaluating the second derivative at $\theta_{\text{MAP}} = 0.16$

$$= -\frac{2}{(0.16)^2} - \frac{10}{(1-0.16)^2} = -72 - 14.4 = -86.4$$

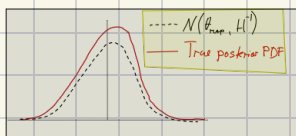
Laplace approximation: the idea is: $\log p(\theta|y) \approx \log p(\theta_{\text{MAP}}|y) - \frac{1}{2} (\theta - \theta_{\text{MAP}})^T H(\theta - \theta_{\text{MAP}})$

- we are building a quadratic approx of $\log p(\theta|y)$ at its peak
- A large negative second derivative (-86.4) means our function is sharply peaked.

Laplace approx. uses this value to define the covariance of the Gaussian

$$\text{Cov}[\theta] \approx -H^{-1}$$

in our case: $\theta \sim \mathcal{N}(\theta_{\text{MAP}}, (-H)^{-1}) = \mathcal{N}\left(\frac{1}{6}, \frac{1}{86.4}\right)$



Hessian of negative log-posterior evaluated at θ_{MAP}
 (prior a point approx.)

$$H = -\nabla^2 \log p(\theta|y)$$

Converting curvature to a Gaussian variance

- for univariate Lap app.

$$q(\theta) = \mathcal{N}(\theta_{\text{MAP}}, A^{-1}), \text{ with } A = -\frac{d^2 \ell}{d\theta^2} \Big|_{\theta=\theta_{\text{MAP}}}$$

- here $A = 86.4 \Rightarrow \sigma^2 = \mathbb{V}[q] = A^{-1} = \frac{1}{86.4} \approx 0.01157$

$$\therefore q(\theta) = \mathcal{N}(0.16, 0.01157)$$

Comparing w/ the true conjugate posterior

$$P(\theta|y) = \text{Beta}(\alpha + y, \beta + N - y) = \text{Beta}(3, 11)$$

o mean

o exact Beta mode $\Rightarrow \theta_{\text{mode}} = \frac{\alpha - 1}{\alpha + \beta - 2} = \frac{(3 + y) - 1}{(3 + y) + (11 + y) - 2} = \frac{1 + 2 - 1}{1 + 2 + 1 + 11 - 2} = 0.1667$

o Laplace ≈ 0.1667

o Variance

o exact Beta variance $\mathbb{V}[\theta] = \frac{\alpha\beta}{(\alpha+\beta)^2(\alpha+\beta+1)} = \frac{(3+y)(11+y)}{((3+y)+(11+y))^2((3+y)+(11+y)+1)} = 0.01122$

o Laplace = 0.01157

Logistic Regression Laplace Approximation

$$\text{dataset} = \{(-2, 0), (-1, 0), (1, 1), (2, 1)\}$$

- design matrix $X = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -2 \\ 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$. shape $(N \times D) = (4 \times 2)$

- targets: $y = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$ slope $(N \times 1) = 4 \times 1$

- we use it in the code $f_n = w^T x_n \Rightarrow f = Xw$

- Parameters vector w

Because $D=2$

$$w = \begin{bmatrix} w_0 \\ w_1 \end{bmatrix}$$

intercept
slope w.r.t. x

- Prior

o Precision $\alpha=1$

$$w \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \alpha^{-1} I_2) = \mathcal{N}\left(\begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}\right)$$

Before seeing the data we expect the intercept and the slope to be around 0.

- Gaussian pdf $p(w) = (2\pi)^{-\frac{D}{2}} \alpha^{\frac{D}{2}} \exp\left(-\frac{\alpha}{2} w^T w\right)$

- log prior $\log p(w) = -\frac{\alpha}{2} w^T w - \frac{D}{2} \log(2\pi) + \frac{D}{2} \log \alpha$

- Likelihood

$$y_n | w, x_n \sim \text{Bernoulli}(p_n), \quad p_n \equiv \sigma(f_n), \quad f_n = w^T x_n$$

- where $\sigma(z) = \frac{1}{1 + e^{-z}}$, Bernoulli pmf: $p(y_n | w) = \sigma(f_n)^{y_n} [1 - \sigma(f_n)]^{1 - y_n}$ $y_n \in \{0, 1\}$

- joint likelihood for the whole data

$$p(y|w) = \prod_{n=1}^N \sigma(f_n)^{y_n} [1 - \sigma(f_n)]^{1-y_n}$$

- taking logarithm

$$\log p(y|w) = \sum_{n=1}^N \left[y_n \log \sigma(f_n) + (1-y_n) \log (1 - \sigma(f_n)) \right]$$

o Combine log-joint $p(y, w) = p(y|w) p(w)$

$$\log p(y, w) = \sum_{n=1}^N \left[y_n \log \sigma(f_n) + (1-y_n) \log (1 - \sigma(f_n)) \right] - \underbrace{\frac{d}{2} w^T w + C}_{\text{prior}} - \frac{D}{2} \log(\det \Sigma) + \frac{D}{2} \log \det \Sigma$$

o derivative picking a single data pt. n and a single coordinate k of the weight vector, the n -th summand is

$$\ell_n = y_n \log \sigma_n + (1-y_n) \log (1 - \sigma_n)$$

- we want $\frac{d\ell_n}{dw_k}$; sigmoid derivative $\frac{d\sigma(z)}{dz} = \sigma(z)[1 - \sigma(z)]$, $f_n = \sum_{i=1}^D w_i x_{ni} \Rightarrow \frac{df_n}{dw_k} = x_{nk}$

chain rule for a composite $g(h(w))$ $\frac{dg}{dw} = g'(h) h'(w)$

o derivative of the positive-class term

$$\frac{d}{dw_k} [y_n \log \sigma_n] = y_n \frac{1}{\sigma_n} \frac{d\sigma_n}{dw_k} = y_n \frac{1}{\sigma_n} \sigma_n (1 - \sigma_n) x_{nk} = y_n (1 - \sigma_n) x_{nk}$$

o Gradient & Hessian

$$\Delta \nabla_w \log p(y, w) = X^T (y - \sigma) - \alpha w$$

$$\Delta \nabla_w^2 \log p(y, w) = -X^T \text{diag}(\sigma \circ (1 - \sigma)) X - \alpha I$$

$\sigma = \sigma(xw)$

o finding map numerically

$$\hat{w}_{\text{MAP}} = \begin{bmatrix} 0.000 \\ 1.006 \end{bmatrix} \Rightarrow f = X \hat{w}_{\text{MAP}} = \begin{bmatrix} -2.013 \\ -1.007 \\ 1.007 \\ 2.013 \end{bmatrix}$$

o curvature of the model

compute the diagonal variance vector

$$V_h = \sigma(\hat{f}_n) [1 - \sigma(\hat{f}_n)]$$

h	1	2	3	4
$\hat{f}_n$	-2.013	-1.007	1.007	2.013
$\sigma(\hat{f}_n)$	0.117	0.267	0.233	0.883
V_h	0.103	0.196	0.196	0.103

plugging into hessian

$$H = -X^T \text{diag}(V) X - I = \begin{bmatrix} 1.59 & 0 \\ 0 & 2.22 \end{bmatrix}$$

o Laplace Gaussian

$$q(w) = \mathcal{N}(\hat{w}_{\text{MAP}}, S) \quad S = (-H)^{-1} = \begin{bmatrix} 0.625 & 0 \\ 0 & 0.449 \end{bmatrix}$$

o Approximating the posterior predictive distribution

- choosing a test input, $x^* = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1.5 \end{bmatrix}$ (intercept + a new $x^* = 1.5$)

compute $m^* = m^T x^* = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1.00 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1.5 \end{bmatrix} = 0.1 + 1.5 = 1.5$

$v^* = x^{*T} S x^* = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1.5 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0.625 & 0 \\ 0 & 0.449 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1.5 \end{bmatrix} = 0.625 + 1.5^2 \cdot 0.449 = 1.6369$

these two scalars summarize everything we need from the entire Gaussian posterior

o Plug-in (Map) approximation

$$P(y^* = 1 | y, x^*) \approx \sigma(m^*) = \frac{1}{1 + e^{-1.5099}} = 0.819$$

we freeze the uncertainty in w , pretend $w = \hat{w}_{\text{MAP}}$ is true, then use the classical logistic link

o Probit Approximation

A logistic curve $\sigma(z)$ can be matched by probit curve $\Phi(z/\lambda)$ if $\lambda = \sqrt{\pi}$. The deterministic replacement let's us do Gaussian integral in closed form because $\Phi(\cdot)$ is the CDF of a normal and the product of the two normals is still a scaled normal

$$\lambda = \sqrt{\pi/\pi} = 0.6267; \quad \frac{m^*}{\sqrt{\frac{\pi}{n} + v^*}} = \frac{1.5099}{\sqrt{1.273 + 1.6369}} = \frac{1.5099}{1.6388} = 0.9215 \Rightarrow P_{\text{probit}} = \Phi(0.9215) = 0.770$$

- interpretation: the denominator inflates the effective standard deviation by $\sqrt{\pi/n}$ before adding v^* ; this correction shrinks the probability towards 0.5 to reflect weight uncertainty

Monte Carlo estimator

- Generate $S = 10,000$ draws of f^* , because f^* is linear in w
 $f^* \sim \mathcal{N}(m^*, v^*) = \mathcal{N}(1.5099, 1.6369)$
- draw 10,000 i.i.d. samples $f_{(i)}^*$ from that normal
- Push each sample through the sigmoid
 Compute $\sigma(f_{(i)}^*)$ and average:

$$p_{MC} = \frac{1}{10,000} \sum_{i=1}^{10,000} \sigma(f_{(i)}^*) \approx 0.763$$
- Standard error $\sqrt{\frac{p(1-p)}{S}} \approx 0.004$, so ± 2 band is roughly $[0.755, 0.771]$

Comparison:

- Plug-in is the most confident as it ignores the uncertainty (v^*)
- Probit & MC are very close. MC ~ Golden standard, but probit is cheap

Summary

- m^* is the best Guess logit for x^* . if $m^* > 0$, class 1 is more likely on average
- v^* encodes how unsure we are about that logit

Three Approximation Methods

- Plug-in: ignore weight uncertainty: just use one weight vector (the MAP)
- Monte Carlo: Sample many weights from posterior, average sigmoid ($x \cdot w$)
- Probit approx: Replace logistic link w/ a probit and do the Gaussian integral in closed form.

All 3 start from $f_* = x_*^T w$ $w \sim \mathcal{N}(m, S)$, the diff. one purely in how they treat the link func
 $p(y_* = 1 | f_*) = \sigma(f_*)$

Task 6.1 Show that the pos. pred prob $p(y^* = 1 | y, x) \rightarrow 0.5$ as variance $v^* \rightarrow \infty$

- in probit you compute

$$p = \Phi(z), \quad z = \frac{m_*}{\sqrt{\frac{p}{1-p} + v^*}}$$

$$\lim_{v^* \rightarrow \infty} \frac{m_*}{\sqrt{\frac{p}{1-p} + v^*}} = 0 \Rightarrow \Phi(0) = \underline{0.5}$$

where $m_* = x_*^T m$ and $v_* = x_*^T S x_*$

For large v_* :

$$z = \frac{m_*}{\sqrt{v_*}} \sqrt{\frac{1}{1 + p/(1-p)}} \rightarrow 0$$

The standard form. CDF satisfies $\Phi(0) = 0.5 \therefore p = \Phi(z) \rightarrow 0.5$

When post. var. of the margin f_* is HUGE, we are unsure whether the latent var. is pos. or neg. so the best calibrated prob. assignment is a coin flip (0.5)

